

Better Questions, Better Answers

The question is the skill

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A short worksheet on writing questions that get you somewhere - for any subject, any learner, any tool.

The Big Idea

AI tools give you answers. The secret: the answer you get is only as good as the question you ask. Learning to ask better questions is the actual skill - not just with AI, but in school, at work, and in life.

Weak vs. Strong Questions

Weak: What is photosynthesis?

Stronger: Can you explain photosynthesis like I am explaining it to a 10-year-old? Include one everyday example.

Weak: Help me with my essay.

Stronger: My essay is about [topic]. The first paragraph feels weak. Can you tell me what is missing and suggest one stronger opening?

Weak: Is this a good idea?

Stronger: Here is my idea: [describe]. What are 3 reasons it could work and 2 reasons it might not?

The Question Upgrade Checklist

[] Did I say WHO this is for? (me, a child, a beginner, an expert...)

[] Did I say WHAT FORMAT I want? (a list, a paragraph, an example...)

[] Did I give CONTEXT? (subject, situation, what I already tried...)

[] Did I set a LENGTH? (short, under 100 words, one sentence...)

[] Is my question SPECIFIC enough that a wrong answer would be obvious?

Practice: Upgrade These Questions

Rewrite each question below using the checklist above.

1. Original: Tell me about the American Revolution.

Your upgrade: _____

2. Original: How do I write a good conclusion?

Your upgrade: _____

3. Original: What should I do for my science project?

Your upgrade: _____

Remember

If the answer is not helpful, do not give up - upgrade the question. Follow up: 'Can you make it simpler?' or 'Give me a different example.' The conversation is where the learning happens.